FREE GUIDE · JOSHUA HEALD

HARD2BREAK YOUR FIRST FREESTANDING HANDSTAND

HOW OFTEN
Train each step 2 times a week, 3 if you're not too sore.

HOW LONG
A month to about 6 months, depending on where you're starting.

YOU NEED
A wall and a bench or chair.

Hit the goal on each step before you move on. That way you don't injure yourself.
Watch the original tutorial →

SHOULDER STRENGTH PHASE 1



STEP 1
THE PIKE WALK
5–10 REPS, 5-SECOND HOLD

1. Plant your hands firmly on the ground and look between your hands.
2. Walk forward, keeping your butt as high as possible, until you're stacked in the pike position.
3. Hold for about five seconds and walk back.



STEP 2
ELEVATED PIKE LEG RAISE
5–10 REPS, 5-SECOND HOLD

1. Put your feet up on the bench and get stacked over your hands.
2. Look between your hands, with your butt as high as possible.
3. Bring one leg up as high as you can, hold for about five seconds, then do the other side.

WALL WORK PHASE 2



STEP 3
WALL CLIMBS
5–10 REPS

1. Plant your hands on the ground and put your feet on the wall.
2. Back yourself up until you're all the way against the wall.
3. Look down for a second, then walk yourself back.



STEP 4
HANDSTAND HOLD AGAINST THE WALL
15–30 SECONDS

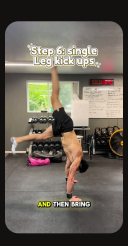
1. Face the wall and put your hands nice and close to it.
2. Kick up and let your heels rest on the wall.
3. Look straight back and hold.



STEP 5
HEEL TAPS
5–10 REPS

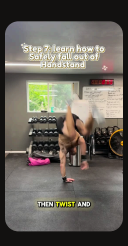
1. Hands nice and close to the wall. Pop up and put your heels on the wall.
2. Look between your shoulders.
3. Press through your fingertips until your heels come off the wall, then bring them back.

KICK UP AND BAIL OUT PHASE 3



STEP 6
SINGLE-LEG KICK-UPS
5–10 REPS EACH SIDE

1. Put your hands firmly on the ground, one foot close and the other all the way back.
2. Kick this leg straight up and let the other leg lag behind a little.
3. Bring yourself back down. This teaches you how to pop up to the handstand.

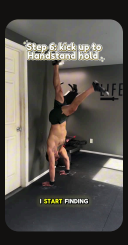


STEP 7
LEARN HOW TO FALL
5–10 FALLS TO THE SIDE

1. Kick up into the handstand.
2. Lift up one of your hands.
3. Twist and fall out to the side.

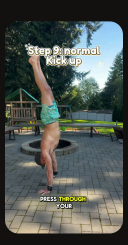
This is what helps you feel safe trying to kick up into your very first handstand.

FIND YOUR BALANCE PHASE 4



STEP 8 · ADDED STEP
KICK UP AND BRING THE OTHER LEG UP
5–10 GOOD REPS

1. Hands close to the wall. Kick up and float.
2. Once you start finding balance, slowly bring the other leg up.
3. Use your fingertips to keep you from touching the wall. Then switch sides.



STEP 9 · ADDED STEP
KICK UP WITH BOTH LEGS
5–10 REPS

1. Kick up with both legs at pretty close to the same time.
2. On the way up, press through your fingertips and relax your arms a little so you don't go all the way over.
3. Float up to the top, find your balance, then come back down.

AFTER THE LAST STEP

Look between your hands, keep your toes pointed and start building your time. Stay close to the wall without touching it for as long as you need. That's how you get your very first freestanding handstand.

READY FOR THE NEXT SKILL?

The Hard to Break Program is six skills, every step from zero, with your workouts planned out. It's launching very soon. Join the waitlist and get two bonuses free: post-training stretching and rest-day mobility.

JOIN THE WAITLIST

Not medical advice. Train at your own risk and stop if something hurts. Terms: hardtobreakprogram.com/terms · @trainerjosh